

12-Week Strength Builder

A four-day upper/lower programme for people who already train, built on steady weekly progression and a deload every fourth week.

Structure

- Mon Upper 1, Tue Lower 1, Thu Upper 2, Fri Lower 2.
- Main lifts: add 2.5 kg (upper) or 5 kg (lower) when all sets are completed.
- Weeks 4, 8 and 12: deload, same exercises at 60% of the weight, half the sets.

Upper 1

- Bench press 4 x 5
- Barbell row 4 x 6-8
- Overhead press 3 x 6-8
- Pull-ups 3 x max (or assisted)
- Triceps pushdown 2 x 12

Lower 1

- Back squat 4 x 5
- Romanian deadlift 3 x 8
- Walking lunge 3 x 10 each
- Leg curl 2 x 12
- Calf raise 3 x 12

Upper 2

- Incline dumbbell press 4 x 8-10
- Lat pulldown 4 x 8-10
- Dumbbell lateral raise 3 x 12-15
- Seated cable row 3 x 10
- Biceps curl 2 x 12

Lower 2

- Deadlift 3 x 5
- Front squat or hack squat 3 x 8
- Hip thrust 3 x 10
- Leg extension 2 x 12
- Hanging knee raise 3 x 12

Tracking

- Write down every weight and rep. If you miss reps two sessions in a row, drop the weight 10% and build back up.
- Sleep 7-9 hours and eat about 1.6 g of protein per kg of body weight to support strength gains.